Discovery Workshop — Facilitator Script

Digital Archive for Business Documents

Meeting type	Discovery (first conversation — nothing drafted yet)
Duration	~90 minutes
Facilitator / Date	_____ _____
Participant(s)	Business owner (essential) · optional follow-up: accountant / tax advisor

> **Your two goals today:** (1) settle the **scope boundary** — archive vs. accounting/invoicing system; (2) surface **retention / compliance** obligations. Everything else is secondary.

Before you start: send the participant the one-page requirements contract as a pre-read. Bring this script printed, with a pen.

0:00 — Open & frame (10 min)

> **Say:** *"Thanks for making time. Today isn't about picking software or deciding how to build anything — it's just so I properly understand what you have, how you work, and what 'done' looks like for you. There are no wrong answers, and 'I don't know yet' is a perfectly good one. I'll be taking a lot of notes."*

Ask:

- In your own words — what made you decide you need a digital archive now? What's the trigger?
- When this is working perfectly a year from now, what's different about your day?

Notes:

0:10 — Document types & sources (20 min)

> **Say:** *"Let's map out everything that would go into this archive, and where it lives today."*

Ask:

- Walk me through the kinds of documents. You mentioned bills you issue to customers, bills you receive for the business, tax papers, contracts — what else falls under "etc."?
- ⚠ **Vocabulary check:** You use "bill" for both what you send and what you receive. Can we agree on names? (proposed: **outgoing invoice** = you issue; **incoming bill** = you receive)

- Where does each type live right now — which local drives, which email accounts/inboxes, and how much is physical paper?
- Is there anything **personal/private** mixed in with the business documents that should **not** go in here?

Notes (list document types + their sources):

0:30 — How you find things (15 min)

> **Say:** "*Pretend a document just came in — or you need one from three years ago. Show me, or talk me through, exactly what you'd do.*"

Ask:

- When you need a specific bill right now, what do you do — and where does it break down today?
- How do you *think* about a document when you go looking for it — by customer? supplier? date? amount? document type? invoice number?
- If you could type one thing into a search box and get the right document, what would you type?

Notes (capture his natural "find-by" model — this drives the whole design):

0:45 — Volume, formats & migrating the old stuff (15 min)

> **Say:** "*Now let's get a rough sense of size — this tells me how big a job the migration is.*"

Ask:

- Roughly how many documents total? And how many new ones arrive/get created per month?
- What formats are they today — PDFs, scans, photos, Word files, paper?
- How far back do we need to go — everything ever, or e.g. the last 7–10 years?
- The physical paper — who scans it, and is that realistic to do?

Notes:

1:00 — Access, security, backup, where it lives (15 min)

> **Say:** *"A few practical questions about who touches this and where it should live."*

Ask:

- Is it just you filing and retrieving documents, or does anyone else — staff, your accountant — need access?
- Any preference or hard constraint on where it lives — your own computer, a network drive, or cloud?
- What happens today if a drive dies? What would you want to happen — how important is automatic backup?
- How comfortable are you maintaining this yourself once it's set up?

Notes:

1:15 — Retention & compliance (10 min)

> **Say:** *"This one may need your accountant, and that's fine — I just want to flag it."*

Ask:

- How long must these documents legally be kept? (Tax rules often require 7–10 years.)
- Are there compliant/tamper-evident archiving rules you have to meet in your jurisdiction?
- For tax time or an audit, what would you need to be able to pull out, and in what form?

Notes (flag anything to confirm with the accountant):

1:25 — Decisions, risks & next steps (5 min)

Confirm these decisions out loud before ending:

☐ **Scope boundary:** store & retrieve only, or also create customer invoices? → _____

☐ **Where it lives:** local / network / cloud → _____

☐ **History to migrate:** how far back → _____

Flag these risks:

- Retention/compliance rules not met → *action:* consult accountant
- Documents left behind during migration → *action:* inventory every source first
- "Archive" quietly growing into a full accounting system → *action:* hold the scope line

> **Close with:** "*Here's what I heard as the big points… [play back 3–4 sentences]. Did I get that right? Anything I missed?*"

Playback / corrections:

After the meeting — facilitator checklist

☐ Fill remaining Open fields in the requirements contract

☐ Update the glossary (lock the "bill" vocabulary)

☐ Book the short compliance consult with the accountant

☐ Hand off to **requirements-writer** to draft high-level requirements

A human — you, with the owner as subject-matter expert — owns every decision recorded here.